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FitFolio backend architecture

Date	Version	Author	Notes
Nov 5, 2026	1.0	Davis Lenover	PoC version

This covers only what the PoC needs. It grows as features are added.

Architecture

Client–server. The phone app is the client. It talks to one backend server over HTTPS, sending and receiving JSON (a REST API).

The server is a modular monolith on a small kernel. It is one FastAPI process with one PostgreSQL database, split into modules. - **Modules:** one per feature. Each is a folder in `src/backend/app/` and owns its own tables. - **Layers:** modules are stacked, and calls only go down. Trading calls market, but market never calls trading. - **Public interfaces:** other modules use a module only through its public files. - **Kernel:** `app/core/` holds what every module shares, and never imports a module. - **Plug-ins:** each module adds its routes to the app through its `plugin.py`, which is listed in `app/registry.py`. - **Adapter:** market gets prices through a provider class, so Finnhub can be swapped for another provider without changing other modules.

The server isn't split into separate services, because a buy must change the balance and the shares in one database transaction (FR_MktAtomicTrade). CI rejects any import that breaks these rules.

The rows inside "Modules" show the stacking. Trading uses market and wallet, activity uses wallet, and wallet uses users. Every module with routes also uses users to get the current user.

The diagram's source is `figures/backend-poc.puml`. After changing it, run this from the repository root to update the PNG:

```
plantuml -tpng docs/Design/SoftArchitecture/figures/backend-poc.puml
```

A module's files

File	What it holds	Other modules may import it
`interface.py`	Functions other modules may call	Yes
`queries.py`	Reads other modules may call. They never write	Yes
`types.py`	Data classes and errors	Yes
`service.py`	The rules. Never commits	No
`models.py`	The tables	No

File	What it holds	Other modules may import it
`routes.py`	HTTP routes. Commits once	No
`plugin.py`	Adds the module to the app: its routes, background work and health check	No, only `app/registry.py`

Leave out any file a module doesn't need. Each module's pull request also adds or updates the module's UML class diagram, `figures/<module>.puml`, and the PNG made from it.

Rules

1. Import another module only through its `interface.py`, `queries.py` or `types.py`.
2. Never import a module above yours in the diagram.
3. Never use another module's tables. A foreign key into them is fine, such as `trades.asset_id` to `assets`.
4. Only routes commit, once per request. Market's poller thread is the one exception: it commits once per poll.
5. Money only moves through wallet. Lock the portfolio first with `wallet.interface.lock_live_portfolio()`. `change_balance` needs what it returns. This way a buy and a step sync at the same time wait in turn instead of deadlocking.
6. Take the time from `app/core/clock.py`, never from `datetime.now()`, so tests can set it.

Design patterns

Four patterns, each used where it solves a real problem.

Plug-in kernel. The kernel (`app/core/` and `create_app()`) doesn't know which modules exist. Each module fills in a `Plugin` in its `plugin.py`, with its routes, any work that runs in the background, and a health check, and `app/registry.py` lists them. Adding a module never changes the kernel. `GET /v1/health` shows each module's health check. A health check is optional, but a module with background work must have one, since that work can fail without any request seeing it. `Plugin` refuses one without it.

Strategy, adapter and factory. Market asks for prices through one interface, `MarketDataProvider`. `FinnhubProvider` adapts Finnhub's API to it, `FakeProvider` makes up prices, and `build_provider` picks one from `MARKET_PROVIDER`. See Market for the diagram.

Dependency injection. Code is handed what it needs instead of fetching it. Routes get a database session and the clock from the kernel, through `Depends(get_db)` and `Depends(get_clock)`. The poller is given its provider, clock and session factory. Tests hand in stand-ins, such as a fixed time or a stub provider.

Read-only records. A module hands other modules frozen copies, such as `AssetInfo` and `CurrentPrice` in `app/market/types.py`, never database rows. That way no module can change another module's tables by accident.

How it runs

When the app starts, the kernel adds each module's routes and starts each module's background work. For market, that is the poller thread, which saves a price for every stock once a minute while the market is open.

A request goes from the kernel to the module's route, which reads through the module's queries.

What the PoC builds

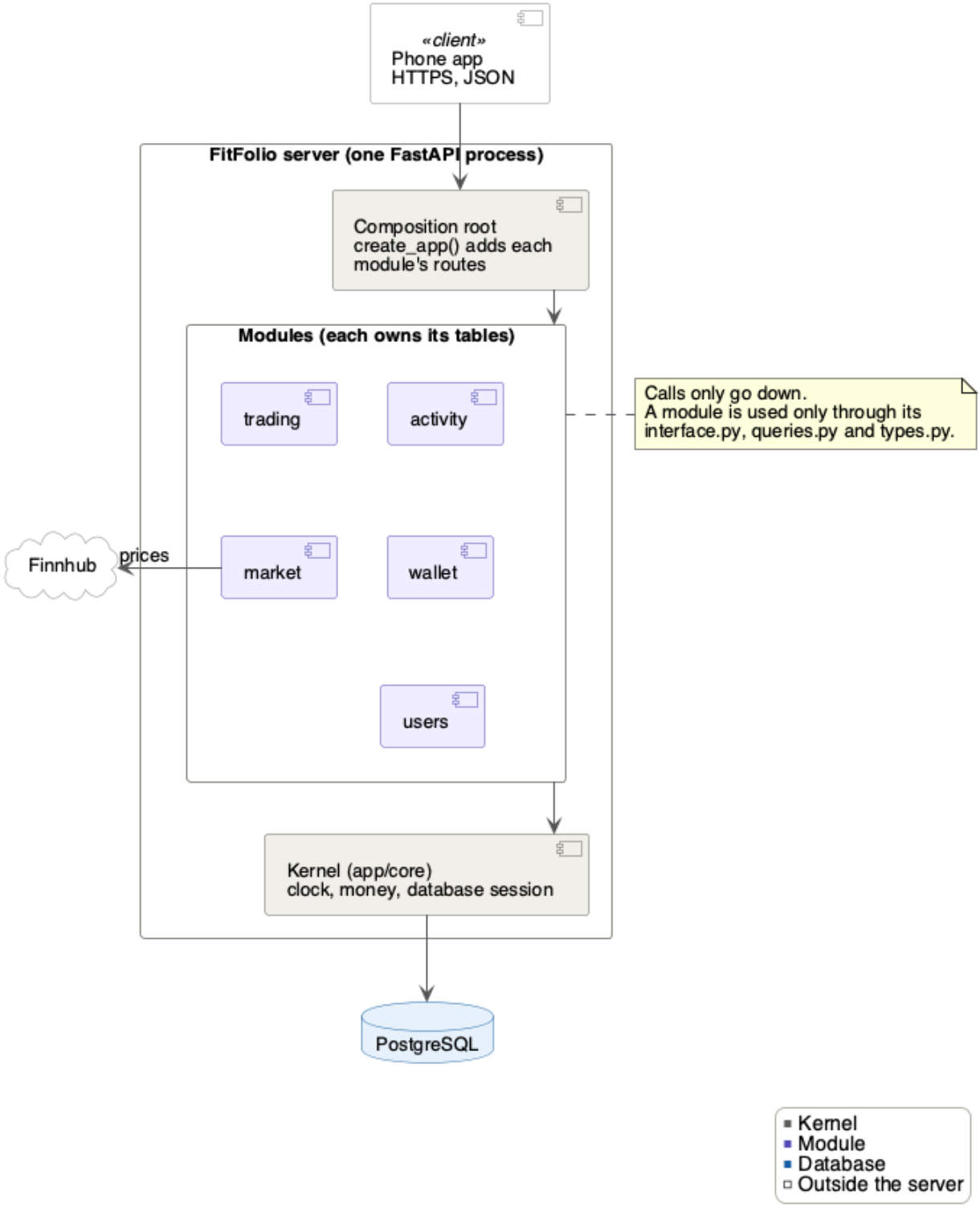


Figure 1: UML component diagram of the PoC backend

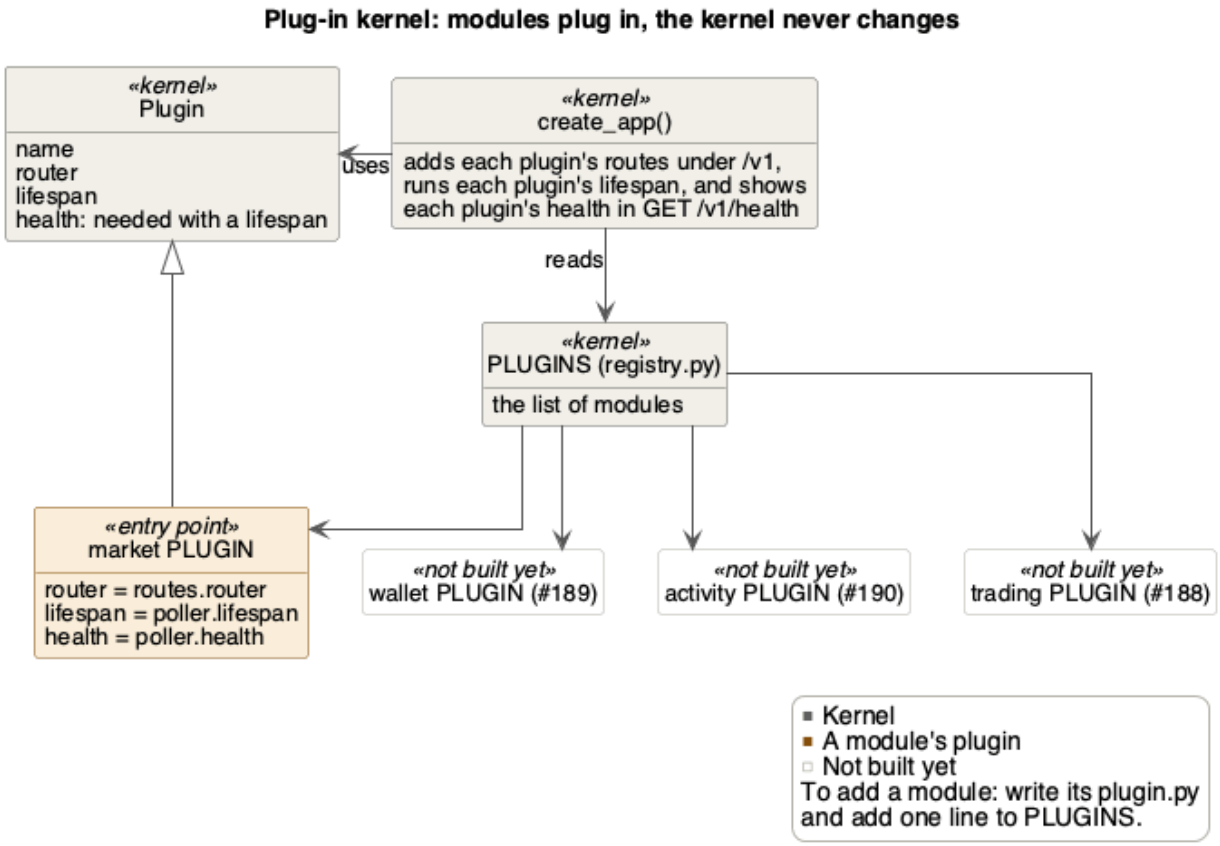


Figure 2: UML class diagram of the plug-in kernel

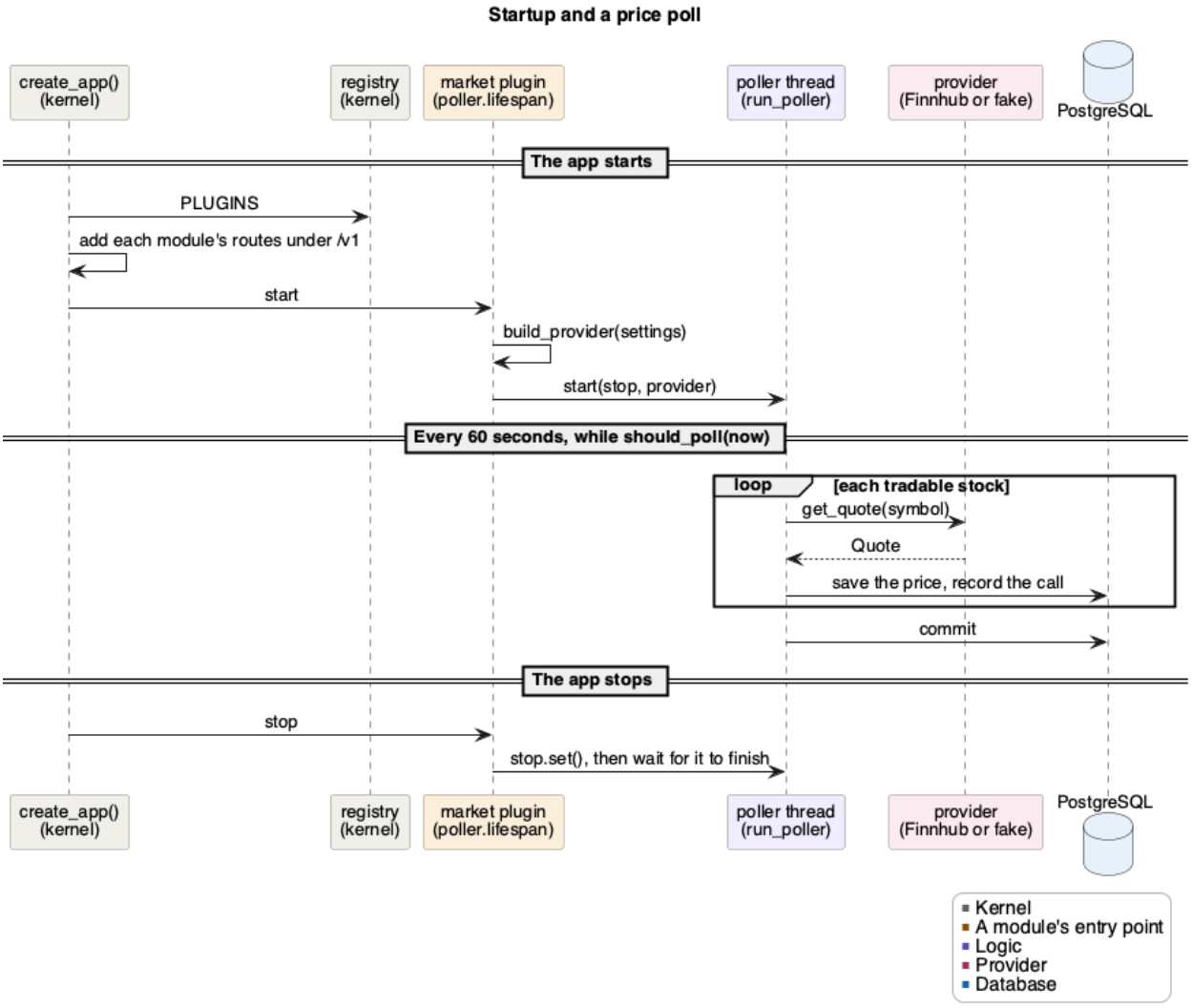


Figure 3: UML sequence diagram of startup and a price poll

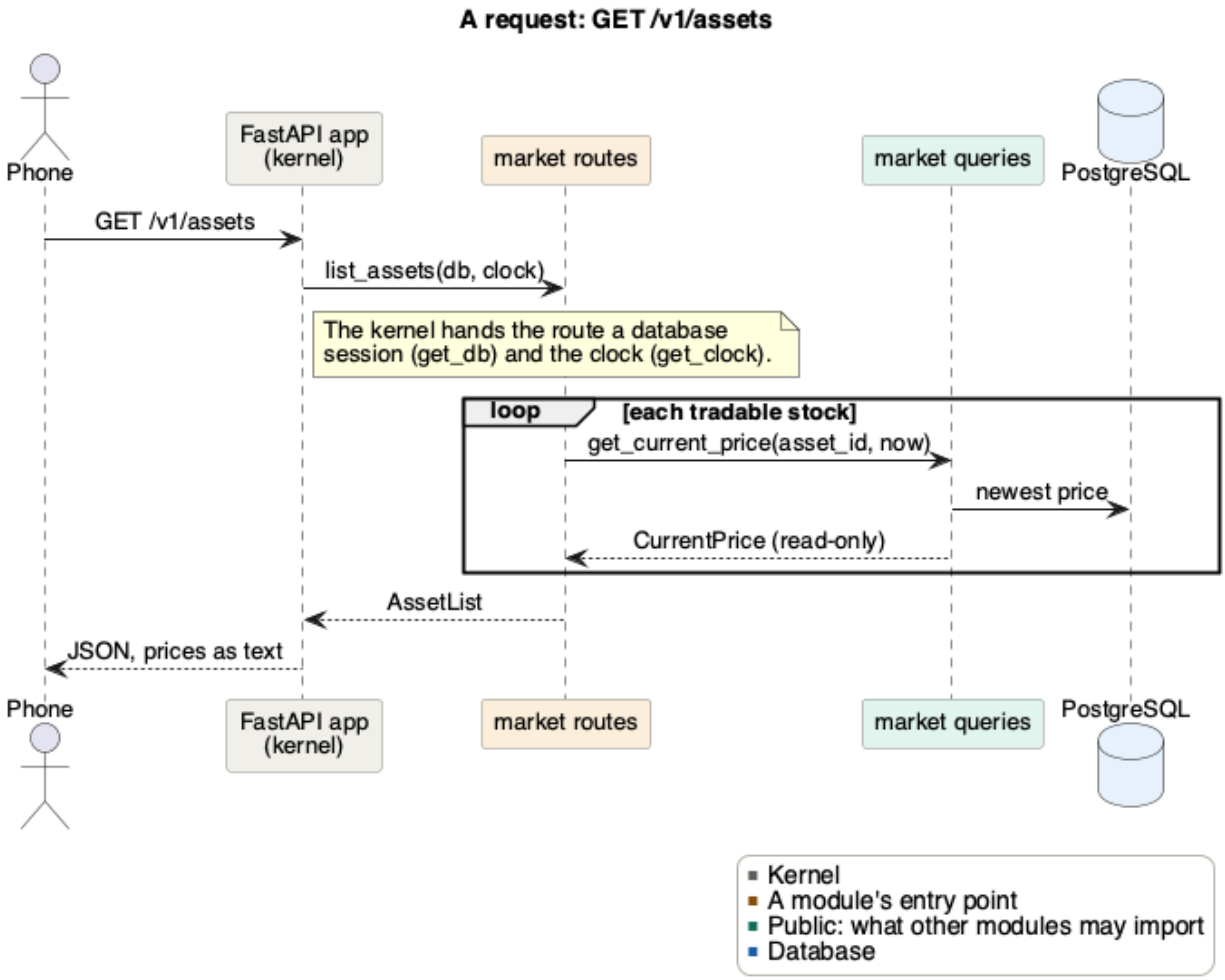


Figure 4: UML sequence diagram of a request for the asset list

Folder	Owns these tables	Routes	Issue
`app/core/`, `app/registry.py`, `app/main.py`	none	`GET /v1/health`	#187, first pull request
`app/market/`	`assets`, `prices`, `provider_requests`	`GET /v1/assets`, `GET /v1/market/usage`	#187
`app/users/`	`users`	none (it provides the demo user)	#189
`app/wallet/`	`portfolios`, `balance_changes`	`GET /v1/me/balance`	#189
`app/activity/`	`activity_daily_totals`	`PUT /v1/me/activity/daily-totals`	#190
`app/trading/`	`trades`, `holdings`	`POST /v1/me/trades`, `GET /v1/me/portfolio`	#188

#187's first pull request sets up the shared pieces. It moves `Money` from `app/api/` into `app/core/`, and the health route into `app/core/routes.py`. It adds `app/core/clock.py` and `app/registry.py`, the list of modules. It also adds `create_app()` in `app/main.py`, which adds each module's routes, and `app = create_app()` keeps `uv run uvicorn app.main:app` working. The price poller is market's own background thread, which market's plugin starts and stops with the app.

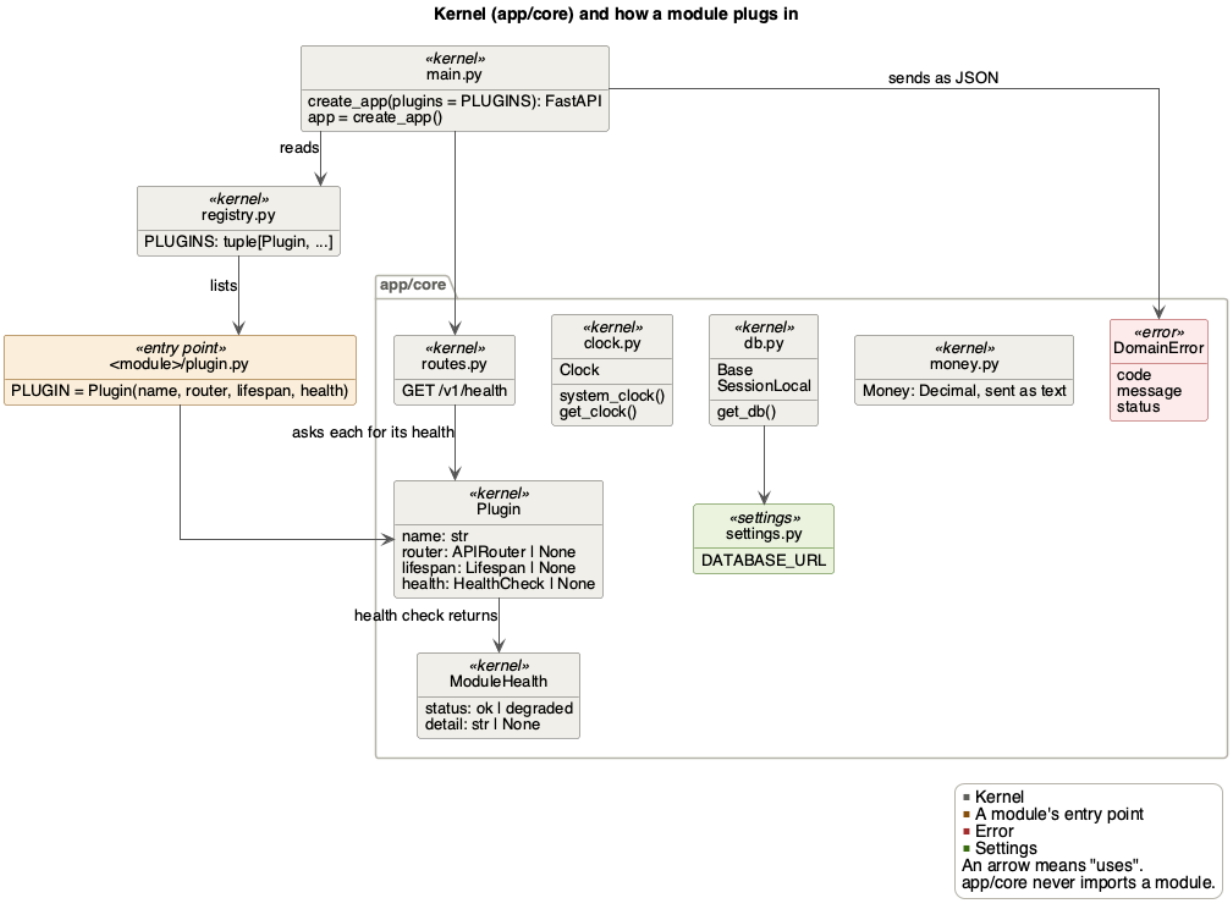


Figure 5: UML class diagram of the kernel and how a module plugs in

#191 adds two checks to CI: - an import-linter rule: no module imports one above it, and `app/core/` imports no module - a test: modules import each other only through their public files

Market: where prices come from

Market gets prices through one interface, `MarketDataProvider`, so the rest of the module never knows which provider it is using.

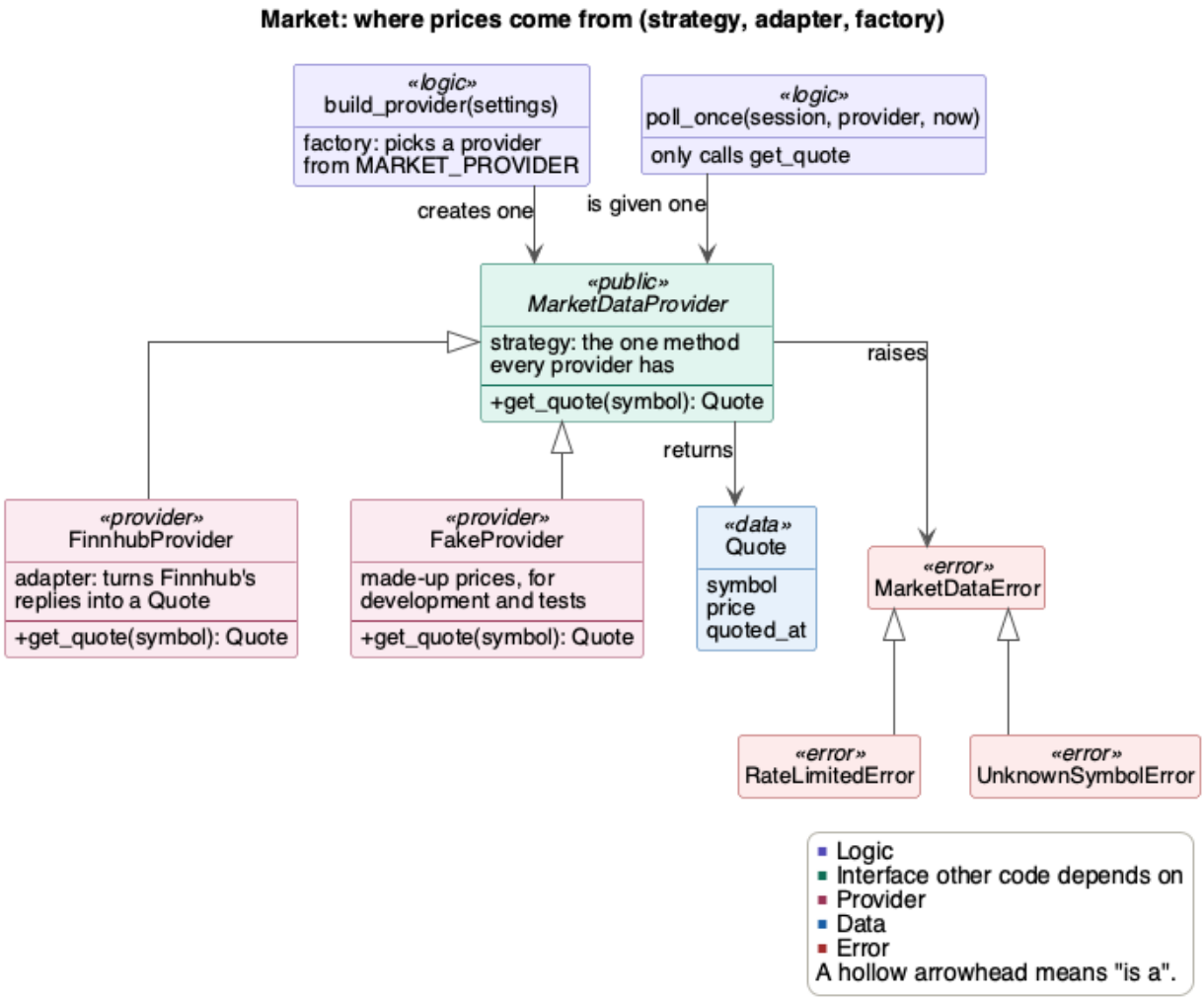


Figure 6: UML class diagram of the market data providers

- **Strategy:** `MarketDataProvider` has one method, `get_quote(symbol)`, which returns a `Quote`: the symbol, the price and when it was quoted.
- **Adapter:** `FinnhubProvider` turns Finnhub's HTTP API into a `Quote`, and its errors into ours, such as `RateLimitedError`.
- **Fake:** `FakeProvider` makes up prices, for development and tests.
- **Factory:** `build_provider(settings)` picks one from `MARKET_PROVIDER`. The poller is given that provider and only calls `get_quote`.
- **Errors:** every provider reports a problem as `MarketDataError` or one of its subclasses, so the poller can record what happened without knowing which provider it has.

To add a provider: 1. Write a class in `app/market/providers/` that names `MarketDataProvider` as its base

and has `get_quote(symbol)`. 2. Add its name to `MARKET_PROVIDER` in `app/market/providers/settings.py` and to `.env.example`. 3. Add it to `build_provider`.

The whole market module, with the parts still to come in grey:

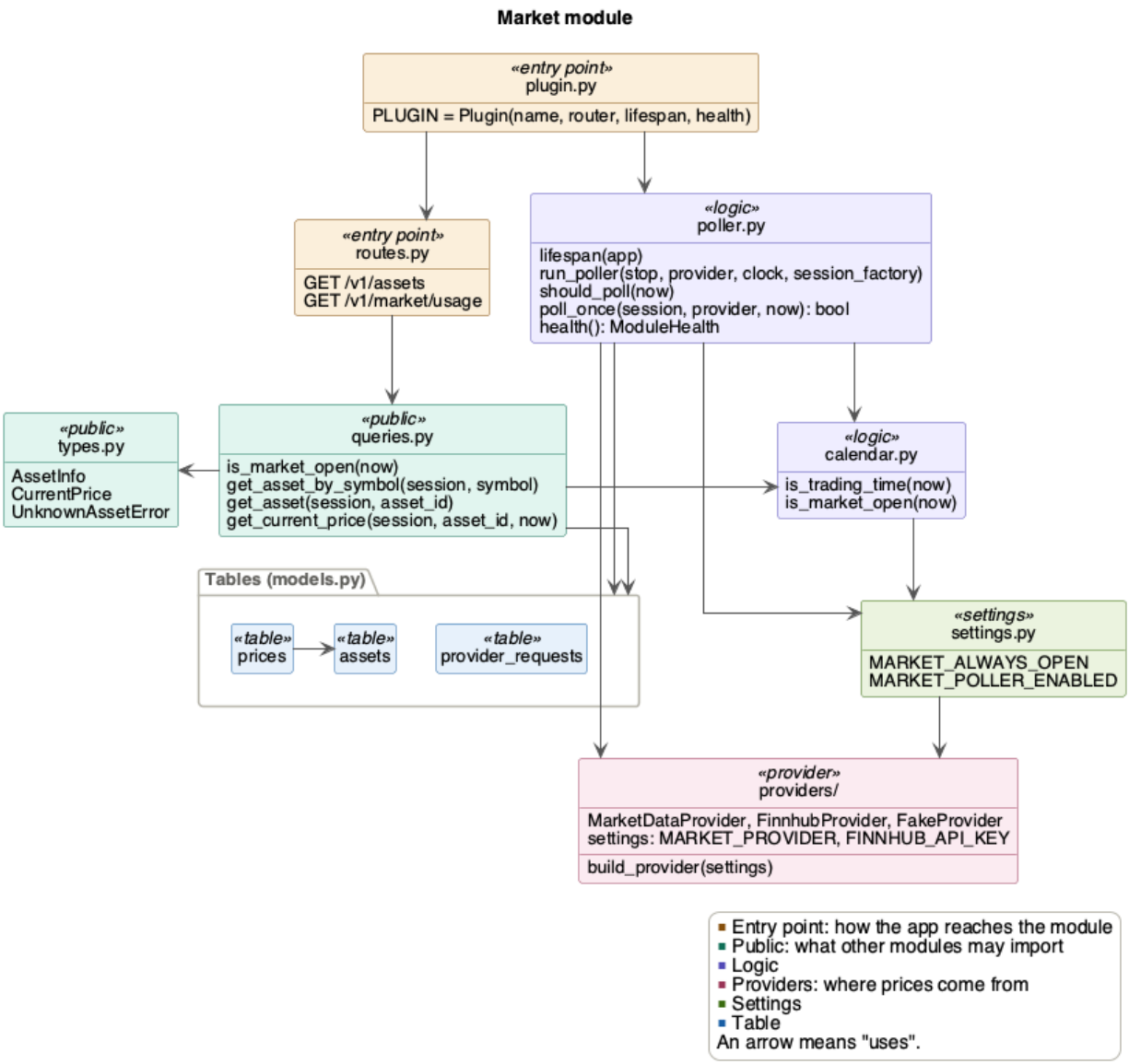


Figure 7: UML class diagram of the market module

Migrations

There is still one chain, and 0001 to 0003 don't change. Name each new migration after its module:

```
uv run alembic revision --autogenerate --rev-id market_0001 -m "provider requests"
```

If `main` gets a new migration while you work, set your migration's `down_revision` to it before you merge. The backend README shows how.